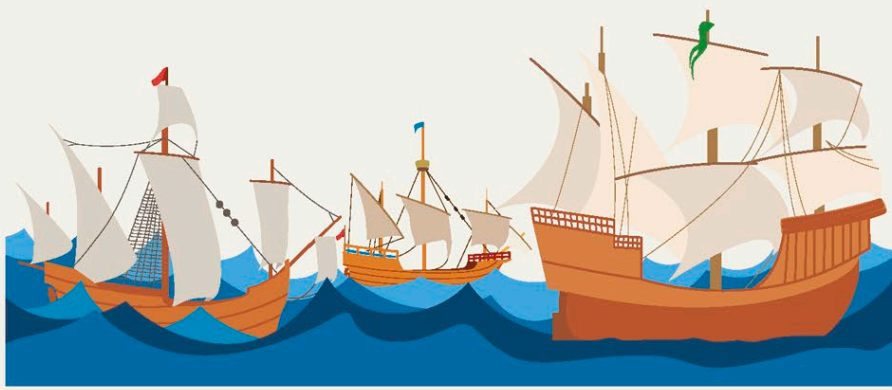




The age of discovery

In the 1450s, big changes began that would bring the Middle Ages to an end. European ships set off on voyages of exploration around the world. There were scientific discoveries and new ideas, which were shared across the continent in printed books. Europeans became the most powerful people in the world, yet they were divided because of religious differences.

1452

Portuguese enslave Africans

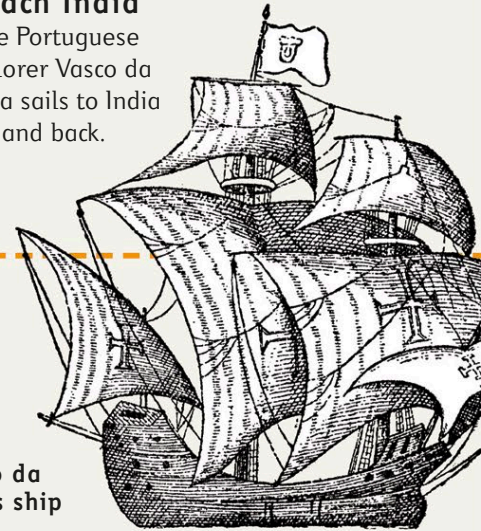
The Portuguese begin to use African slave labor in their sugar plantations in Madeira.

1497–1498

Portuguese reach India

The Portuguese explorer Vasco da Gama sails to India and back.

Vasco da Gama's ship



1525

Inca Empire

The Inca Empire of Peru is at its height.

1520–1566

Suleiman the Magnificent

Reign of Suleiman the Magnificent, the most famous Ottoman sultan.

1519–1522

World voyage

Ferdinand Magellan leads a Spanish expedition in the first crossing of the Pacific. One of his ships sails on to make the first voyage around the world.

1529

Siege of Vienna

Suleiman the Magnificent lays siege to Vienna, capital of Austria, but is not able to capture the city. The Ottoman advance into Europe is stopped.

1532

Conquest of the Incas

Spaniards, led by Francisco Pizarro, conquer the South American Inca Empire.

1534

Church of England founded

In England King Henry VIII argues with the Pope and declares himself head of the new Church of England.



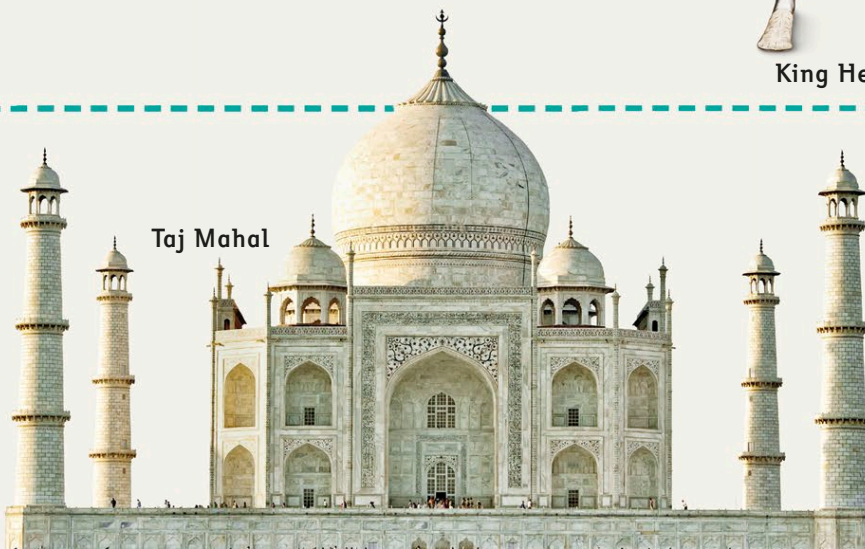
King Henry VIII

1631–1648

Taj Mahal

The Mughal emperor Shah Jahan builds the Taj Mahal, in memory of his favorite wife, Mumtaz Mahal.

Taj Mahal



1619

African slaves in North America

The first African slaves are brought to North America by the English.